

Obituary

Moe Tunick, 83, sibling in prominent family

Moe Tunick, 83, of Stamford, the last of six Tunick brothers that included a judge, a doctor and a collector of antique automobiles, died Wednesday, Nov. 19, at Stamford Hospital. He was a native and resident of Greenwich, until moving to Stamford in 1940.



Tunick

David P. Tunick of Stamford and New York City, his son, said the cause of death is yet to be determined.

Mr. Tunick joined the family business as a partner in Tunick Brothers, a Stamford landmark on West Main Street adjacent to American Cyanamid from 1928 until the 1970s. Originally dealers in automobile parts and trucks, the business evolved into an international trade in army surplus vehicles and equipment.

In a 1950 interview in the B'nai B'rith Times, he said: "One week we'll be rushing to lead a freighter of half-tracks for Cuba where they're used to pull cane carts; then we'll be busy assembling five tons of replacement tank parts for the Venezuelan army; or sending equipment to Guatemala to haul bananas out of the mountains; and right now we're

working on a shipment of army vehicles for shipment to the Korean front."

He and his brothers often worked with Hollywood moviemakers and, in one instance, supplied all the military vehicles for the 20th Century Fox film "The Desert Fox," starring James Mason as Rommel.

Mr. Tunick made his earliest livelihood in show business as a piano player, touring with Moe Tunick and His Silvertone Orchestra. He brought such celebrities as Eddie Cantor, Duke Ellington and Floyd Patterson to Stamford for local causes.

The Tunick brothers were prominent collectors and dealers of antique automobiles, buying them mostly as children for \$5 and \$10 each and warehousing them throughout the Northeast. These ranged from an 1898 Black (a horseless carriage steered by a stick not a wheel) to Model T Fords, Bugattis and a prize-winning Locomobile. He was made a lifetime member of the Automotive Hall of Fame & International Association of the Automobile Industry.

In the mid-1950s, Mr. Tunick became a land developer. His projects included a 1,300-acre Danbury-Bethel parcel that became headquarters of the Burndy Corp. and the Terre Haute Golf Club; the Rip van Winkle bowling alleys in Norwalk; a Stratford sports facility, where he was a partner with Ralph Branca, the pitcher for the Brooklyn Dodgers; and several Stamford residential areas, including 50 acres off upper Newfield Avenue. He named many of the streets he built in Stamford, such as Sweetbriar Road, Butternut Lane and Malibu Drive.

Born Feb. 22, 1914, in the family's house in Bruce Park in Greenwich, he was the youngest child of the late Barney and Sarah Trachtenberg Tunick, who moved to Greenwich in 1907. David P. Tunick said the family had a barn for animals behind the house, where they milked their own cow.

He attended Greenwich public schools and graduated from

Greenwich High School in 1932, then attended the University of Pennsylvania, where he studied business administration.

Mr. Tunick was an active leader in local charities. He was involved in causes sponsored by the Lion's Club, Circus Saints & Sinners, Senior Men's Association of Stamford, Temple Beth El and B'nai B'rith. He was a founding member of the Rockrimmon Country Club and a member of the All Stamford Club and the Midtown Club.

He was predeceased by his five brothers, Abraham Tunick, Jacques C. Tunick, David H. Tunick, Judge Archibald H. Tunick and Dr. George L. Tunick; a sister, Ruth Lichtenstein; a daughter, Carolyn Jean Tunick; and a granddaughter, Alison Hope Tunick.

In addition to his son, David P. Tunick, he is survived by his wife of 57 years, Marion L. Leferman Tunick; two other sons, Edward J. Tunick of Norwalk and Budd L. Tunick of Stamford; a daughter, Susan T. Shepherd of New Canaan; and five grandchildren.

The funeral is scheduled for 1 p.m. tomorrow at Temple Beth El, Roxbury Road, Stamford. Burial will be in Temple Beth El Cemetery.

Donations may be made in his memory to Temple Beth El.

Arrangements are by the Leo P. Gallagher & Son Funeral Home.

Jean Conan Doyle, 84, last survivor of author

Associated Press

LONDON — Dame Jean Conan Doyle, 84, the last surviving child of Sir Arthur Conan Doyle, died Tuesday.

She was a child of Conan Doyle's second marriage, which also produced two sons. In later years she kept a critical eye on adaptations of her father's work, especially the Sherlock Holmes stories.

After her brother Adrian died in 1971, she took on the job of administering the copyrights.

She was commissioned in the

Death Notices

TO PLACE A DEATH NOTICE

Monday thru Friday
8:30am — 5:00pm
Saturday 9:00am — 1pm
Sunday 11:00am — 1pm
CALL 964-2315

TO PLACE AN IN MEMORIAM, CARD OF THANKS, MASS NOTICE

Monday thru Friday 8:30am — 5pm
Saturday 9am — 1pm
CALL 629-2204 from Greenwich